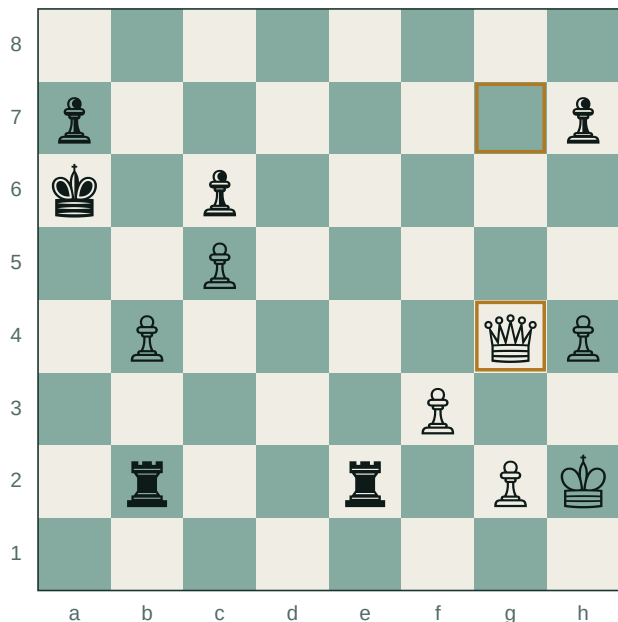


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 45

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 45.Qg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45...Rxg2+ 46. Qxg2 Rxg2+ 47. Kxg2 Kb5

45...Rxg2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From g2 it attacks king on h2 and queen on g4. Recorded reply: **46.Qxg2**.

46...Rxg2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on g2. Recorded reply: **47.Kxg2**.

47...Kb5 The king moves from a6 to b5.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h2. Absolute pin: pawn on g2.